



THE **ROCKEFELLER** BLUEPRINT

A Modern Advisor's Guide to Building a
Virtual Family Office



THE GREAT WEALTH MIGRATION & THE ROCKEFELLER SOLUTION

The largest wealth transfer in history is underway. Over the next two decades, \$30 trillion will move from Baby Boomers to their Generation X and Millennial children. This unprecedented shift isn't just about money changing hands—it represents a fundamental transformation in how wealth is managed and preserved across generations.

While Baby Boomers often worked with a single advisor for decades, their children bring different expectations. They seek integrated solutions, demand technological sophistication, and expect their advisors to coordinate with other professionals seamlessly. This generational shift is forcing a revolution in how advisory practices operate.

Forward-thinking advisors are looking to history for answers, specifically to an innovation that transformed wealth management over a century ago.



In 1882, John D. Rockefeller faced a challenge that resonates with today's wealth holders: how to preserve and grow wealth across generations while navigating increasingly complex financial landscapes. His solution would revolutionize wealth management and create a blueprint that remains relevant today.

"The ability to deal with people is as purchasable a commodity as sugar or coffee," Rockefeller wrote, "and I will pay more for that ability than for any other under the sun."

This philosophy led him to pioneer the family office model—bringing together elite professionals under one roof to coordinate all aspects of his family's wealth.

Rockefeller understood something that top advisors recognize today:

"Don't be afraid to give up the good to go for the great."

He saw that traditional, siloed approaches to wealth management weren't sufficient for preserving multi-generational wealth. His letters to his son emphasized that true wealth preservation required more than just investment management—it demanded a coordinated team of specialists working together toward common goals.

"The most important thing, is to establish a credit...a reputation, character."

This focus on trust and reputation became the cornerstone of the family office model. By bringing together tax professionals, legal counsel, investment managers, and other specialists under one roof, Rockefeller created a comprehensive approach to wealth management that would preserve his family's legacy for generations.

Today, as \$30 trillion begins changing hands, advisory practices face a critical choice: evolve to meet the complex needs of the next generation or risk becoming irrelevant. Leading advisors are finding their answer in a modern adaptation of Rockefeller's innovation—the Virtual Family Office.



THE ROCKEFELLER BLUEPRINT: FROM FAMILY OFFICE TO VIRTUAL FAMILY OFFICE

When John D. Rockefeller established his family office in 1882, he wasn't just solving his own challenges—he was creating a wealth management model that would endure for generations. In letters to his son, Rockefeller laid out principles that remain strikingly relevant for today's advisors:

"I believe it is every man's religious duty to get all he can honestly and to give all he can."

This philosophy shaped how the Rockefeller family office operated, focusing not just on wealth accumulation, but on preservation and purposeful transfer across generations.

The Original Model's Key Elements



Coordinated Specialists

Rather than relying on disconnected advisors, Rockefeller brought specialists together under one roof. This wasn't just about convenience—it was about creating a team that could see the complete picture of his family's wealth and work together to protect and grow it.



Proactive Planning

The family office didn't wait for problems to arise. They anticipated challenges, identified opportunities, and developed comprehensive strategies before they were needed. This forward-thinking approach became a hallmark of the model.



Multi-Generational Focus

Perhaps most importantly, the family office wasn't built for just one generation. Rockefeller knew that preserving wealth across generations required educating and preparing heirs while creating sustainable structures for wealth transfer.

The Virtual Evolution

Today's leading advisors are taking these core principles and adapting them for a new era. The Virtual Family Office maintains the essence of Rockefeller's model while leveraging modern technology and collaborative practices to make it accessible to a broader range of clients.



Virtual Collaboration

Instead of housing everyone under one roof, the Virtual Family Office uses technology to coordinate a team of independent specialists. This dramatically reduces overhead while maintaining the benefits of collaboration.



Scalable Service Model

While traditional family offices served only the ultra-wealthy, the virtual model can be adapted for different client segments. This allows advisors to deliver family office services to clients who previously couldn't access this level of comprehensive planning.



Enhanced Client Experience

Modern technology platforms enable clients to interact with their entire advisory team through a single point of contact, maintaining the simplicity of the original model while expanding its capabilities.

The Virtual Family Office isn't just an adaptation of Rockefeller's model—it's an evolution that makes comprehensive wealth management accessible to a new generation of clients. As one advisor put it: "We're not just preserving wealth anymore; we're preserving family legacies in a digital age."

Legacy of Innovation

The genius of Rockefeller's model wasn't in creating a family office—it was in recognizing that complex wealth requires coordinated specialists. Today's Virtual Family Office builds on this insight, using modern tools to deliver:



**Comprehensive
Planning
Integration**



**Coordinated
Professional
Knowledge**



**Multi-
Generational
Wealth Strategies**



**Technology-
Enabled
Collaboration**



**Scalable
Family Office
Services**

As we face the largest wealth transfer in history, these principles are more relevant than ever. The Virtual Family Office model offers advisors a proven framework for serving the next generation of wealth holders, built on time-tested principles but adapted for modern needs.

THE MODERN VIRTUAL FAMILY OFFICE: A NEW MODEL FOR A NEW ERA

As wealth becomes more complex and client expectations evolve, the Virtual Family Office model offers a powerful solution for both AUM and insurance-focused advisors. But what exactly makes a modern VFO different from a traditional advisory practice?

Core Elements of Success

1. The Central Advisory Team

Unlike traditional practices where one advisor tries to handle everything, or they refer clients out to other professionals, successful VFOs build a core team that includes a:



2. The Specialist Team

Modern VFOs maintain relationships with dozens of key specialists, that are available 24/7, in 5 core areas:



The key difference? These specialists aren't just referral partners—they're integral team members who collaborate regularly on client solutions.

Real World Impact

Consider how this model transforms client service:

Traditional Approach

- Client identifies need for estate planning
- Advisor refers client to attorney
- Hopes for feedback
- Waits for client to coordinate

VS

VFO Approach

- Team proactively identifies estate planning opportunity
- Advanced Planning Specialists schedules collaboration meeting
- Estate planning specialist joins strategy session
- Team develops integrated solution
- Proactive Coordinator ensures implementation
- Team reviews and tracks progress

Technology as the Enabler

Modern VFOs leverage technology to deliver coordinated service without the overhead of a traditional family office:

- Secure client portals for document sharing
- Virtual meeting platforms for team collaboration
- Project management systems for tracking deliverables
- Client relationship management tools for coordinated communication

From the client's perspective, the VFO delivers:

- One primary point of contact
- Coordinated professional advice
- Proactive planning across all areas
- Regular team reviews
- Seamless implementation
- Family legacy planning

This comprehensive approach works equally well for clients focused on personal finances, business issues, investments, or insurance—because it starts with planning rather than products.

Measuring Success

Leading VFOs track their impact through multiple metrics:



Client Retention Rates



Client Satisfaction Scores



Multi-Generational Engagement



Professional Introductions



Revenue per Client



Team Efficiency

Most importantly, they measure their ability to help clients achieve their broader family and legacy goals, not just financial targets.

This model creates several sustainable advantages, including multiple revenue streams beyond traditional fees. It also is a protection against commoditization. For advisors willing to embrace this evolution, the VFO model offers a clear path to building a practice that can thrive through the great wealth transfer and beyond.

BUILDING YOUR VIRTUAL FAMILY OFFICE: A BLUEPRINT FOR SUCCESS

While the Virtual Family Office model offers compelling advantages, successful implementation requires careful planning and awareness of common pitfalls. Here's how leading advisors are building sustainable VFOs while avoiding typical mistakes.

1. Team Structure



Success Factor: *Build your core team progressively*

- Start with essential roles: Lead Advisor, Planning Specialist, Client Coordinator
- Add specialists based on client needs, not theoretical possibilities
- Establish clear roles and responsibilities from day one

Common Mistake: *"The Build It All Trap"*

Many advisors try to implement every possible service immediately, leading to overwhelm and poor execution. Start with core services and expand methodically based on client needs.

2. Professional Relationships



Success Factor: *Quality over quantity*

- Focus on finding specialists who embrace collaboration
- Establish clear communication protocols
- Create structured review processes
- Start with 1-2 trusted professionals in each key area

Common Mistake: *"The Loose Network"*

Having a list of professionals isn't enough. Without structured collaboration, important details fall through cracks. Regular team meetings and clear protocols are essential.

3. Technology & Systems



Success Factor: *Start simple, scale smartly*

- Begin with essential tools: CRM, document sharing, meeting platform
- Add complexity only as team capacity grows
- Focus on client-facing efficiency
- Ensure all team members are properly trained

Common Mistake: *"Technology Overload"*

Implementing too many systems too quickly leads to confusion and inefficiency. Choose core tools that integrate well and expand gradually.

The ERT Advantage

Building a Virtual Family Office from scratch requires significant time, resources, and expertise. That's why Elite Resource Team (ERT) has created a turnkey solution that makes this powerful model accessible to any growth-minded advisor.



Why Advisors Choose ERT

Instead of spending 12-24 months building a Virtual Family Office from the ground up, you can leverage ERT's established platform to:

- Launch your VFO in 45 days or less
- Access immediate revenue opportunities
- Minimize implementation risks
- Scale efficiently and predictably

Schedule a strategy session to assess your practice's readiness and identify your biggest opportunities. To learn more, scan below or visit elitert.com.



APPENDIX



Virtual Family Office Readiness Checklist

Use this checklist to assess your readiness to join a Virtual Family Office.

- ☐ Do you have high income and successful business owner clients?
- ☐ Do you want to attract more business owner clients?
- ☐ Do you like proactively planning with your clients, or do you prefer to just sell products?
- ☐ Are you burnt out of the traditional transactional model?
- ☐ Are you tired of studying sales techniques and want to start solving real problems?
- ☐ Do you spend way too much on marketing, just to try to sell yourself to new prospects?
- ☐ Do you question the value of traditional financial advisory services?
- ☐ Do you sometimes look around the room at conferences and say "Yuck, I don't want to be a part of this group!"
- ☐ Do you feel like you have so much more potential to help your clients?
- ☐ Do you like collaboration, or do you prefer to work in a silo?